widely read periodical *Economic and Political Weekly*, senior civil servant Alok Sheel summed up a series of complaints about the international financial institutions by concluding that "[t]he IMF has effectively become a European Monetary Fund, and the World Bank a bank for small, poor economies."[211] In other words, the Bretton Woods institutions were serving neither the needs of India nor those of other developing countries.

There are thus two strong reasons for India to cooperate with the BRICS in employing collective financial statecraft: to magnify its own voice and preferences and to push back against the incumbent powers' use of their international financial capabilities to support their political preferences.

Managing Financial and Political Relations with China

Despite clear gains from exercising collective financial statecraft through the BRICS club, the collaboration houses challenges for India, especially in relation to its long-term rival, China. India appreciates the added weight that participation within the BRICS gives to many of its own positions and preferences about global financial and monetary governance. Indian leaders also recognize that Chinese financial resources are essential for the exercise of BRICS financial statecraft—and that bilateral trade and financial relations with China have become increasingly important within India. At the same time, India is wary of Chinese intentions and does not wish to damage its recently improved relations with the West.[212] Moreover, India, a country with a vibrant democracy, has often been uncomfortable with China's autocratic governance at home, particularly vis-à-vis minorities, including Tibetans.

For India, as for its fellow non-Chinese BRICS, the primary relationship within the club is with its Chinese neighbor, and the meteoric emergence of China since the 1990s as a major world power makes Indians very nervous. Indians have neither forgotten China's surprise attack across the border in 1962, which resulted in Chinese control of Himalayan territory that India still claims, nor forgiven China's provision of nuclear weapons technology to neighboring Pakistan. Indian academics and officials also long have felt competitive with China over each country's relative progress in poverty alleviation, export promotion, economic growth, and most recently financial development.[213] China has been India's major trading partner since 2009, but the reverse is not true, creating an asymmetrical vulnerability. India